I visited Columbia on December 27, 1949. Dawson had had a bad time with his ulcer and it was his first day back at work. Gerry Krueger, the beautiful redhead who had argued feminism with me, had just gotten her doctorate.

The next day I had lunch with two gentlemen from Unicorn Press, who had taken Pebble in the Sky. One was Hans Stefan Santesson, fat, bottom-heavy, and very soft-spoken with the trace of a Swedish accent. The other was Clayton Rawson, tall and long-faced.

Present also was Martin Greenberg, roughly my age and with a Brooklyn accent like mine, but with a mustache added. He had missed out on Pebble in the Sky, he admitted, but he was anxious to do a collection of my robot stories. I was eager to have him do it, since Bradbury had told me he was interested only in novels and not in short-story collections.

On December 29, I had lunch with Bradbury. He had a preliminary copy of Pebble in the Sky with him and gave it to me, smiling his delight at my reaction.

My first book!

I held it in my hand as an actual existing entity four days before my thirtieth birthday, although it was not to be published officially for over three weeks.

Brad was less than encouraging, however, concerning my new novel, The Stars, like Dust—. No contract. He would give me an option for $250 to keep me working, but he would have to see six or seven chapters now before a contract would be possible, and the six or seven would not include the first two chapters—which he was throwing out.

I had apparently committed the customary sin of the sophomore novel. The first novel was fine since I was writing as a novice and had no reputation to uphold. Once it was accepted, however, I was a "novelist" and had to write the second novel while keeping that reputation secure, which meant I had to write deeply and poetically and wittily and so on.

Bradbury got my error across to me very easily.

He said, "Do you know how Hemingway says, 'The sun rose the next morning/ ? "

Somerville ^jj